ACTIVEEDGE

Performance Sportswear — Built for the Planet

Business Case

PROJECT PRESENTATION | PRP372S

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Group Setup & Roles

Our group is made up of five members, with responsibilities split based on each section of the assignment. We tried to match tasks to each person's strengths while making sure the workload stayed balanced.

Name & Role	Task Responsibility
Abdullahi Farah (Group Leader)	Business Idea Development & Value Proposition
Touheed Ismail (Researcher)	Market Research & Community Context
Jaden Abrahams (Writer / Editor)	5W Marketing Strategy & Problem Definition
Lebohang Mosimane (Designer)	Document Design & Formatting
Entle Hlakuva (Presenter)	Validation Evidence & Survey Analysis

While everyone had a specific area to focus on, we worked together throughout the whole process to review each other's work and make sure the final document came together properly. It was genuinely a team effort.

Community Context

This project focuses on fitness-active South Africans, mainly young adults between 18 and 35 years old living in cities like Cape Town and Johannesburg. Wellness culture in South Africa has grown a lot recently. More people are joining gyms, signing up for running events, cycling clubs, and yoga studios than ever before.

Even with all this growth, affordable high-performance sportswear that is also environmentally responsible is still hard to come by for the average South African. International brands like Nike and Lululemon dominate the market at price points most local consumers simply cannot afford. Cheaper local alternatives exist, but they tend to sacrifice either quality or sustainability.

The people in our target market include students, young professionals, and fitness enthusiasts who care about both their health and their impact on the environment. The frustrating part is that existing products rarely address both needs at the same time, which is exactly the gap we identified.

Problem Definition

What Is the Problem?

The core issue is that there is no South African brand that seriously combines performance, sustainability, and affordable pricing in one product. Right now, consumers have to make a trade-off: go with a premium international brand that works but costs way too much, or settle for budget gear that wears out quickly and is made in ways that harm the environment.

The fast-fashion model that most affordable sportswear relies on makes this worse. Synthetic fibres end up in landfills, the production process uses enormous amounts of water, and there is very little accountability for the environmental damage caused. At the moment, no South African-born brand credibly fills this gap.

Who Does It Affect?

- Young fitness enthusiasts (18–35) who want quality gear but are working with a limited budget
- Environmentally aware consumers who want their purchases to actually reflect their values
- Women, who are particularly underserved in the local performance-wear market when it comes to inclusive sizing
- Gym-goers, runners, yoga practitioners, and outdoor sports participants across South Africa's urban areas

How Often Does the Problem Come Up?

This is not a once-off issue. Every time someone needs to replace worn-out gear or make a purchasing decision, they run into the same trade-off. Budget sportswear typically lasts between 6 and 12 months of regular use, which means consumers face this problem multiple times a year. For eco-conscious shoppers, every purchase comes with some level of guilt or compromise. The problem also gets worse at certain times of year — particularly at the start of summer (October/November) and in January when New Year fitness goals are driving demand.

Why Is It Worth Solving?

- It gives local consumers access to durable, performance-grade sportswear at prices that actually make sense for the South African market
- It reduces textile waste by using recycled and sustainably certified materials throughout production
- It creates local employment in ethical manufacturing and design
- It builds a South African brand that can genuinely compete in the global sustainable fashion conversation
- It allows consumers to make purchasing decisions that line up with both their fitness goals and their environmental values

Validation Evidence

Survey Overview

To make sure our idea was grounded in real market data, we put together a survey using Google Forms and shared it across Cape Town and Johannesburg. We collected responses from over 30 participants and asked them about their current sportswear habits, what frustrates them most, and how they feel about sustainability as a purchasing consideration.

The survey had 8 questions covering demographics, spending behaviour, pain points, environmental attitudes, and interest in a brand like ActiveEdge. Here's a summary of what we found.

30+	91%	81%
Survey Respondents	Would Buy ActiveEdge	Prioritise Sustainability

Figure 1 — Biggest Sportswear Pain Points

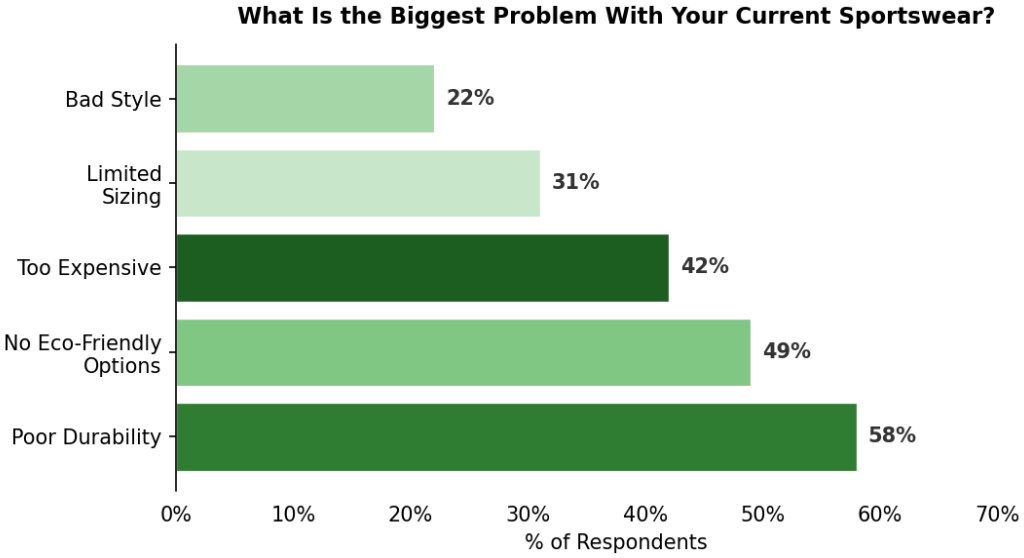


Figure 1: Survey responses to "What is the biggest problem with your current sportswear?" (n = 30+)

Poor durability came out as the top pain point at 58%, closely followed by a lack of eco-friendly options at 49%. These two findings are really central to what we're trying to do with ActiveEdge — they validate both the performance angle and the sustainability angle of our solution.

Figure 2 — Sustainability as a Purchasing Factor

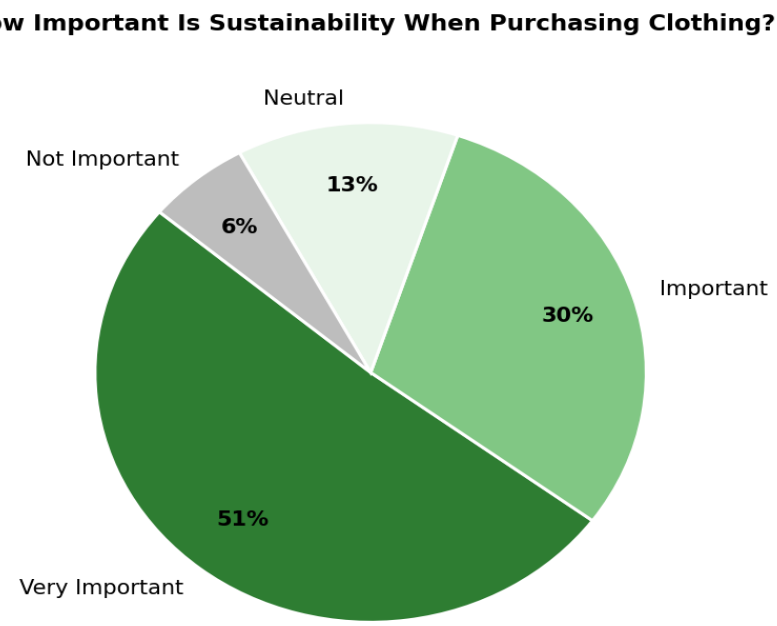


Figure 2: How important is sustainability when purchasing clothing? (n = 30+)

A combined 81% of respondents said sustainability is either "Important" or "Very Important" when they make purchasing decisions. This was one of the most encouraging findings because it shows the market is already thinking this way — they just don't have a local product that meets that expectation at a reasonable price.

Figure 3 — Purchase Intent vs Brand Satisfaction

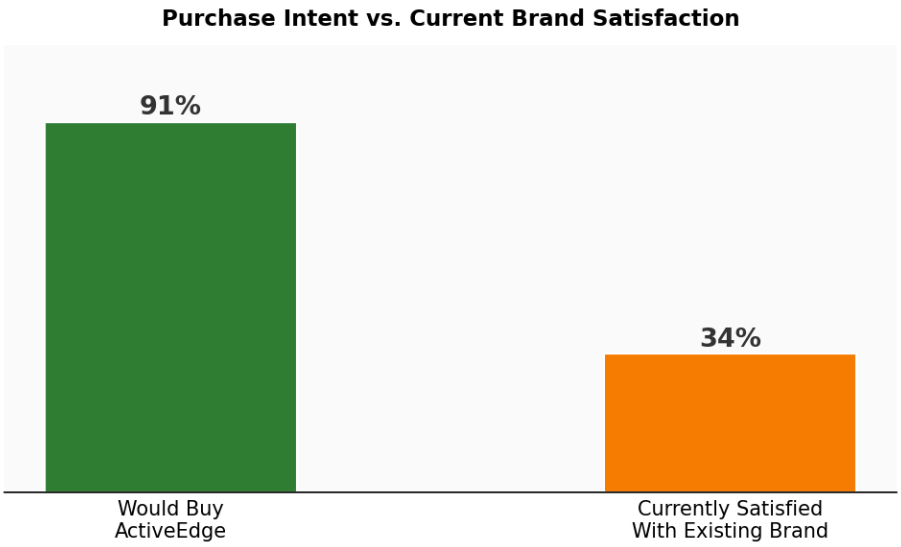


Figure 3: Comparison between willingness to buy ActiveEdge and current brand satisfaction levels

This chart shows one of the clearest opportunities we identified. Only 34% of respondents said they're actually satisfied with their current sportswear brand, yet 91% said they would purchase or at least consider buying eco-friendly performance wear if it was competitively priced. That gap is exactly where ActiveEdge sits.

Figure 4 — Current Spending Per Item

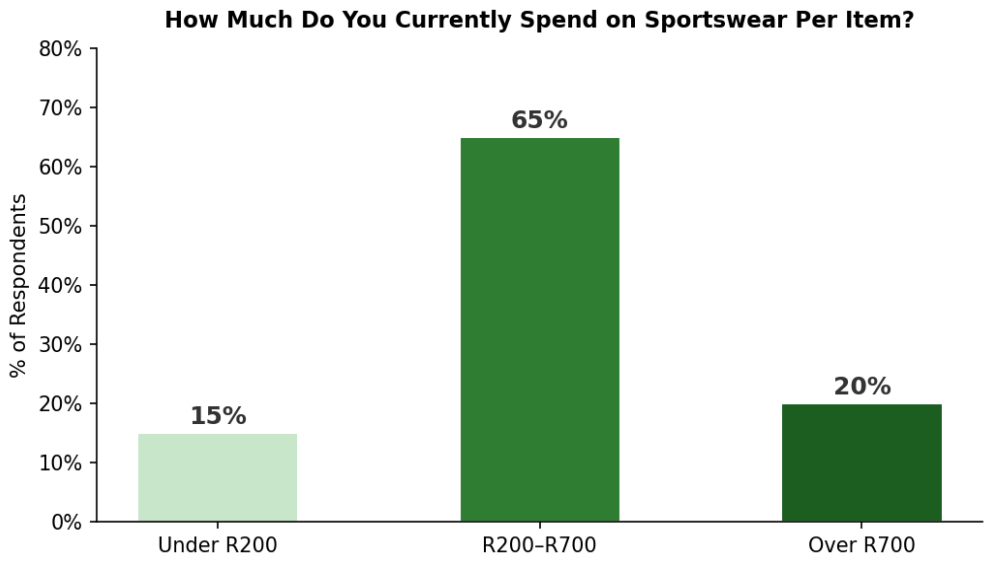


Figure 4: How much respondents currently spend on sportswear per item

65% of respondents are currently spending between R200 and R700 per item. This fits neatly into our target pricing range of R250–R650, which means we're not asking people to change their spending behaviour — we're just offering them a better product for what they're already willing to pay.

Figure 5 — Gender Breakdown of Respondents

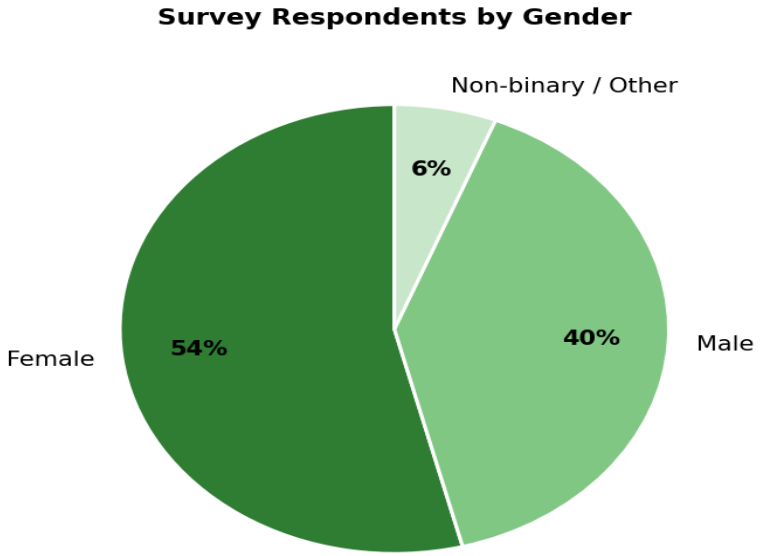


Figure 5: Survey respondent breakdown by gender

The majority of respondents (54%) identified as female, which aligns with research showing that women are generally the primary buyers in the activewear market. It also reinforces why inclusive sizing and functional design for women is such a priority for ActiveEdge.

Key Takeaways

- Our target demographic is clearly represented — the majority of respondents are young, fitness-active adults who exercise at least three times a week

- Poor durability and lack of eco-friendly options are the dominant pain points, directly validating ActiveEdge's core offering
- Low brand loyalty in the current market (only 34% satisfied) signals real room for a new differentiated brand to enter
- The pricing sweet spot of R200–R700 per item matches our planned range, reducing the barrier to adoption
- 91% purchase intent is an exceptionally strong signal that the concept resonates with the market

Proposed Business Solution

The Business Idea

ActiveEdge is a South African fitness apparel brand that specialises in high-performance, environmentally friendly sportswear for men and women. The goal is to position the brand between the premium international labels that dominate the top end of the market and the budget local alternatives that dominate the bottom — and to do it without compromising on either quality or sustainability.

Products

- Leggings — high-waisted, four-way stretch, moisture-wicking
- Sports bras — medium and high-impact support options
- Tank tops and performance tees — breathable, odour-resistant fabrics
- Shorts — training and running styles for both men and women
- Outerwear — lightweight running jackets for South Africa's variable weather

All products are manufactured using recycled polyester, organic cotton blends, and other certified sustainable materials. Packaging will be plastic-free and fully recyclable.

How It Solves the Problem

ActiveEdge is built around three pillars that directly respond to what the research showed us:

Pillar	What It Means in Practice
Performance	Fabrics are selected to handle the technical demands of high-intensity training — proper moisture management, stretch, and durability that outlasts conventional alternatives
Sustainability	Recycled and eco-certified materials throughout, reducing textile waste and the environmental footprint of every garment
Accessibility	Competitive local pricing (R250–R650 per item) removes the financial barrier that currently keeps quality performance gear out of reach for most South African consumers

5W Marketing Strategy

Our marketing approach is built around the 5W framework. It's a useful way of making sure every decision we make around campaigns, channels, and messaging is grounded in a clear understanding of the customer and what actually drives their purchasing behaviour.

W	Dimension	ActiveEdge Answer
WHO	Target Customer	Fitness-active adults aged 18–35 who value both performance and sustainability
WHAT	Product / Benefit	High-performance, eco-friendly sportswear made from certified recycled materials
WHERE	Channel / Touchpoint	Online store, Instagram/TikTok, gyms, wellness stores, and pop-up events
WHEN	Purchase Triggers	New Year resolutions, seasonal transitions, fitness milestones, and Black Friday
WHY	Competitive Edge	Unique blend of sustainability + style + performance at accessible local pricing

1. WHO — Who Are We Talking To?

The core ActiveEdge customer is a fitness-active South African, typically aged between 18 and 35, based in an urban area, and exercising at least three times a week. They care about performance — they want gear that actually works — but they're also thinking about sustainability and they're price-sensitive in a way that most international brands don't acknowledge.

There's also a secondary buyer persona worth noting: people purchasing as gifts for a birthday or a fitness milestone. Both personas respond well to social proof — reviews, influencer recommendations, and hearing about the brand from people they trust.

2. WHAT — What Are They Getting?

Customers aren't just buying gym clothes. They're investing in performance, sustainability, comfort, and in some ways identity. ActiveEdge products are designed to wick moisture, allow full freedom of movement, and maintain their structure over months of intense use. Beyond the functional benefits, customers also get the knowledge that their purchase supports ethical manufacturing and a genuinely South African brand story.

3. WHERE — Where Do We Reach Them?

- Online store (primary channel) — direct-to-consumer with fast local delivery
- Instagram and TikTok — organic content, fitness influencer collaborations, and targeted paid advertising
- Pop-up events and fitness expos in Cape Town and Johannesburg
- Partnership retail through selected independent gyms, wellness studios, and health stores

4. WHEN — When Do They Buy?

- January — New Year fitness resolutions create the highest volume of sportswear purchases throughout the year
- October/November — the start of summer and peak outdoor activity season in South Africa

- Black Friday — a major opportunity to bring in new customers with first-purchase discounts
- Fitness milestones — completing a race, hitting a training goal, or joining a new gym all prompt gear refreshes

5. WHY — Why Choose ActiveEdge Over Everyone Else?

The short answer is that no other local brand is doing all three things at once: real performance, genuine sustainability, and pricing that South African consumers can actually afford. ActiveEdge is not trying to greenwash — every claim about materials is measurable and certifiable. The brand is also authentically South African, designed for local conditions and local consumers, which gives it an emotional connection that imported brands simply can't replicate.

- Recycled and eco-certified materials in every product — not marketing spin
- Inclusive sizing across a wider range than most local alternatives
- Pricing 30–50% below comparable international brands
- A South African brand story that genuinely resonates with local consumers

Value Proposition

ActiveEdge helps fitness-active South Africans aged 18–35 who are tired of choosing between quality, sustainability, and affordability in sportswear, by offering a locally designed, high-performance activewear brand made from recycled eco-certified materials — so that they can train at their best, reduce their environmental impact, and feel genuinely good about every purchase they make.

Element	Detail
WHO	Fitness-active South Africans, aged 18–35, who exercise regularly
PROBLEM	Existing sportswear is either unaffordably premium, low-quality, or environmentally harmful — no local brand credibly offers performance, sustainability, and accessibility at the same time
SOLUTION	A South African activewear brand manufacturing high-performance sportswear from recycled and eco-certified materials at accessible price points
BENEFIT	Train better, reduce environmental impact, support local — without compromising on quality or breaking the bank

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